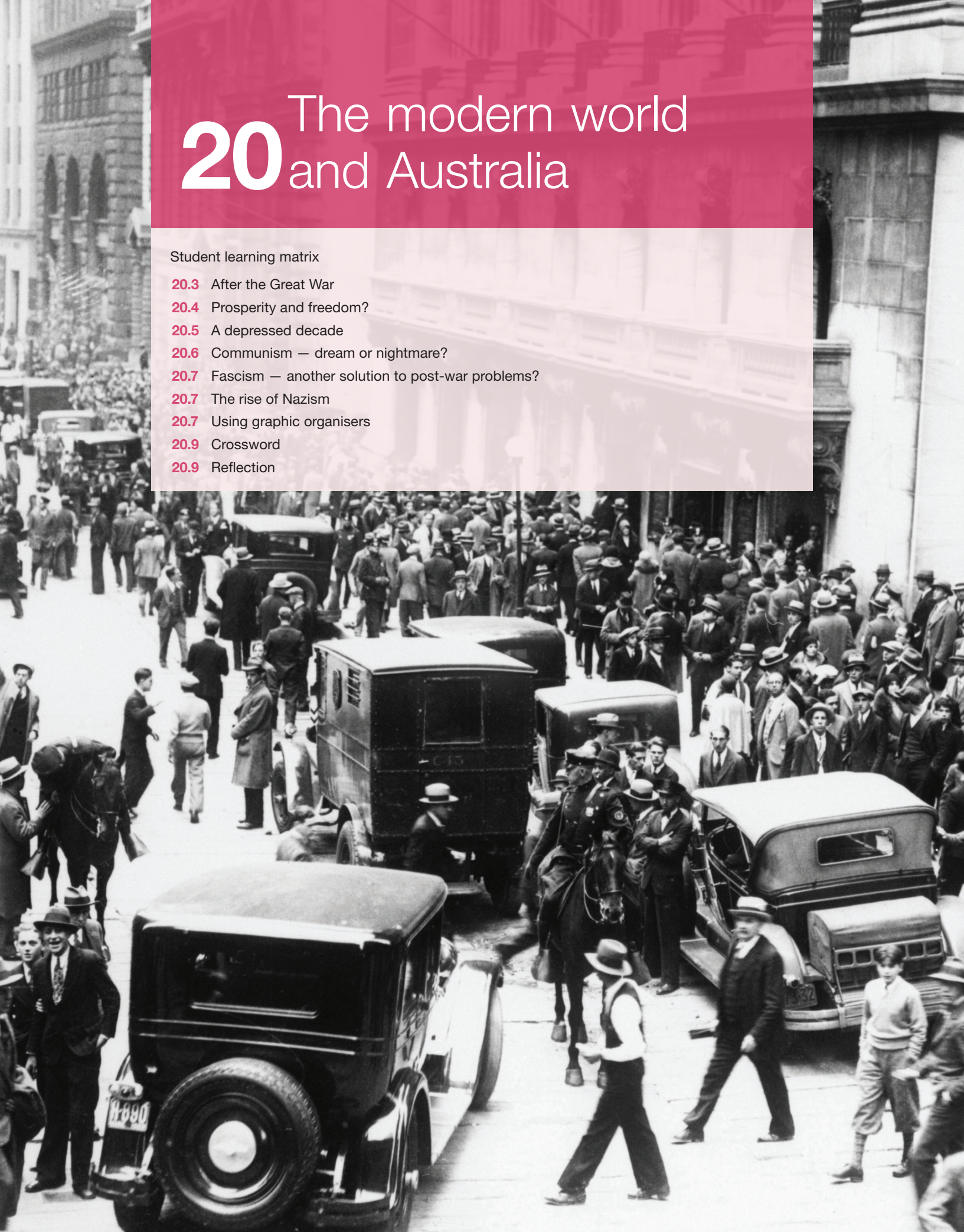


20 The modern world and Australia

Student learning matrix

- 20.3 After the Great War
- 20.4 Prosperity and freedom?
- 20.5 A depressed decade
- 20.6 Communism — dream or nightmare?
- 20.7 Fascism — another solution to post-war problems?
- 20.7 The rise of Nazism
- 20.7 Using graphic organisers
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- 20.9 Reflection



After the Great War

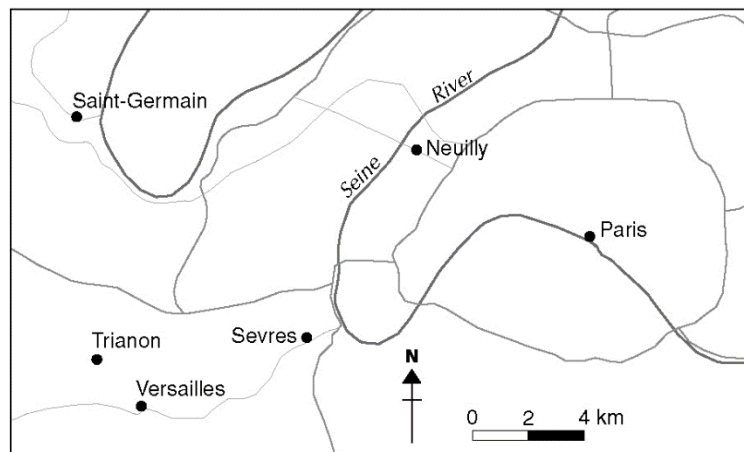
Student: Class: Due date:

Various post-war treaties attempted to sort out disputed borders, clarify ongoing relations between nations and demand reparations.

1. Complete the following summary of treaties and their outcomes:

Treaty of Versailles

- a. **When** 28 June 1919
- b. **Who?** Who were the signatories? Delegates from the Allied nations and Germany
- c. **What?** What was the outcome for Germany?
 Germany lost territory, including colonies; had reduced armed forces; was banned from trading in or making armaments; lost control of coal fields; and was required to make reparations to Allied countries.
- d. **Germany's role and response**
 - i. How did Germany participate in the forming of the treaty? Germany was involved in negotiations with other signatories for five months.
 - ii. Why, then, do you think the German people were upset by the terms of the treaty? The penalties were too severe and humiliating.



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Treaty of Saint-Germain

Outcome? Austro-Hungarian Empire lost territory to Yugoslavia; Austria paid reparations.

.....

Treaty of Neuilly

Outcome? **Bulgaria lost territory to Greece, Romania and Yugoslavia.**

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.....

Treaty of Trianon

Outcome? **Hungary lost territory to Czechoslovakia.**

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Treaty of Sèvres

Outcome? **Turkish Ottoman Empire lost territory to League of Nations.**

.....

.....

.....

2. A new-look Europe

a. Which central European empire ceased to exist? **The Austro-Hungarian Empire**

.....

b. How do you think its citizens would have felt? **Some would have been happy to return to Austria.**

and Hungary respectively; some might have felt ashamed of their role in the war; some would have felt angry and resentful at having their empire carved up.

c. Which nations were re-established? **Poland, East Prussia, Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia, Finland**

d. How do you think their citizens would have felt? **Grateful and relieved but with much work ahead**

e. Which nations were created? **Yugoslavia and Czechoslovakia**

3. Describe the League of Nations by completing the following:

a. What was its primary aim? **To avoid further wars**

.....

b. What were some of its other goals? **At an international level, to resolve legal disputes, combat**

epidemics and deal with industrial and economic problems.

.....

- c. Although the league had 42 members, why do you think it was sometimes called a ‘toothless tiger’?

The league had no real power (for example, no army of its own) to enforce its orders and ultimatums; all its decisions had to be unanimous, so a single member could prevent the league taking action. Some powerful nations were not members, and other members left.

Prosperity and freedom?

Student: Class: Due date:

Capitalism is an economic system in which goods and services are produced by private companies or individuals to make a profit. In many countries, this economic system was on the rise in the decade following World War I.

1. What were the pros and cons of capitalism after World War I? Complete the following table.

	Pros	Cons
Boom in manufacturing, including assembly lines	Cheaper goods, so sales increased, and wealth increased for producers and retailers. Increased production meant more jobs and therefore more people with money to spend.	Hire purchase schemes lured people to spend beyond their means. Wages did not keep pace with the increased cost of living.
Increased prosperity	Many people could afford new home appliances, such as fridges, and car ownership increased.	The divide between the wealthy and the poor increased, especially in Europe and Britain. Not all benefited; for example, demobilised soldiers, rural workers and African Americans did not all prosper.

2. Also on the rise was socialism — an economic system that aims to share wealth and benefits equally among all citizens.

- a. Which social classes feared the rise of socialism? Why?

The upper and middle classes feared socialism because it would require them to share their wealth with the working classes and peasants.

- b. Why do you think that, in the 1920s, socialism was an attractive option for some?

Despite prosperity for some, there was unemployment and poverty for others. The war may have made people fearful of trusting a minority with decision-making power for all.

3. a. Describe some new aspects of life during this period, in which women experienced freedom and independence.

Women's fashions were more daring, and women smoked, drank alcohol and bathed at beaches with men.

- b. Why do you think women behaved differently after the war?

They had taken on men's roles while men were at war, so had become used to being independent socially and economically. They continued with some of the traditionally male practices, such as drinking and smoking in public.

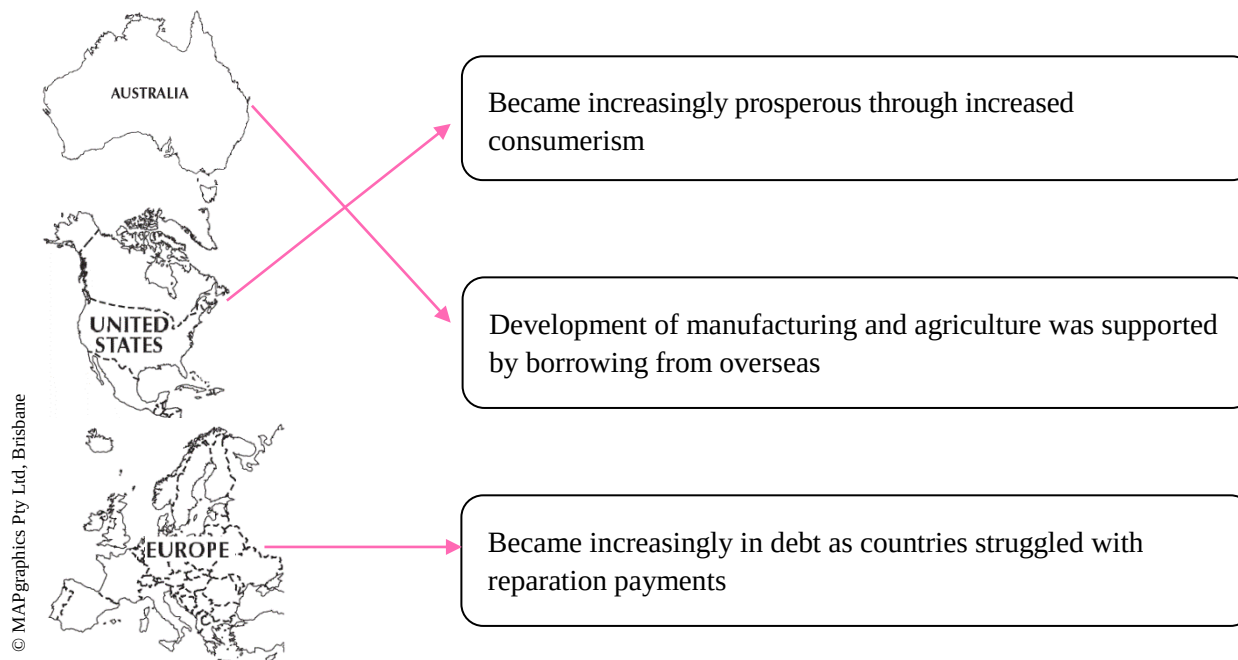
4. Why do you think that, post-war, many colonies also wanted freedom and independence?

Sample response: The Great War showed that countries could resist imperial expansionism, so many felt encouraged to reject their colonial masters.

A depressed decade

Student: Class: Due date:

1. Draw an arrow from the continent to the correct description of its situation from 1919 to 1929.



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AUSTRALIA

UNITED STATES

EUROPE

Became increasingly prosperous through increased consumerism

Development of manufacturing and agriculture was supported by borrowing from overseas

Became increasingly in debt as countries struggled with reparation payments

2. What triggered the Great Depression on 24 October 1929?

The Great Depression was triggered by the collapse of the American stock exchange.

3. Using written and visual information from the topic, give an account of conditions for Australians from 1929 to 1939 by writing one or two sentences about each of the following:

Unemployment: There was a sharp rise in unemployment, peaking at 29 per cent in 1932 and still at nearly 10 per cent in 1939. The unemployed found queuing for the dole humiliating.

Children: Children often suffered the most through malnutrition and preventable diseases. Some were so hungry they collapsed at school.

Housing: People could not pay their rent or make housing repayments. Many families were evicted, and shantytowns sprang up, housing up to 400 000 people.

4. a. Below is a brief summary of each of the three recovery plans for Australia. Rank them from 1 to 3 where 1 is what you consider the best plan.

Students' answers will vary.

.....

Lang Plan: Refuse to pay Australia's international debt; use the funds for welfare programs.

Jack Lang, Labor Premier of NSW

Print more money to encourage spending and stimulate industry; this would create jobs.

E.G. Theodore, Labor Federal Treasurer

The Melbourne Agreement: Cut wages, pensions and other costs and pay back loans steadily.

Commonwealth and state premiers

- b. Give a reason for your first preference.

Students need to explain how the plan might help people, perhaps in both the short term and the long term.

.....

Communism — dream or nightmare?

Student: Class: Due date:

The Tsar, or Russian monarch, abdicated the throne in 1917 and the Bolshevik Party came to power — a party based on communist principles.

1. **Underline the correct terms to complete the following summary of how the dream of communist equality for all led to a dictatorship.**

Although the first Bolshevik government tried to put *capitalist*/.....**communist**..... ideals into practice,**economic**...../political failure forced it to appoint managers to run business and agricultural enterprises. To *increase*/.....**retain**..... power, the Bolsheviks *encouraged*/.....**banned**..... other political parties. But some Russians wanted a return to a **monarchy**...../democracy, and others wanted a return to a multi-party system. All revolts were **crushed**...../negotiated. When the Bolshevik leader,**Lenin**...../Trotsky/Stalin, died in 1924, *Lenin/Trotsky*/.....**Stalin**..... used his position as secretary of the Communist Party to become dictator of *Russia*/.....**the USSR**.....

2. a. **Which groups in society do you think might have supported communism? Why?**

Those in town-based industry and manufacturing might have supported communism because they would have enjoyed financial support from the government for their enterprises and because they were guaranteed food.

- b. **Which groups in society do you think might NOT have supported communism? Why?**

Rural peasants would not have supported communism because their food was taken from them and given to factory workers or exported; millions starved. Political prisoners and many factory workers were treated harshly, and people lived in fear of being sent to labour camps if they questioned the government.

3. **Explain how Stalin maintained power by using the following:**

Fear: **Stalin controlled people by making them fearful of execution or being sent to a labour camp.**

Propaganda: **Through propaganda, he convinced them he was the source of life — almost like a god.**

Censorship: **He limited people's access to information and ideas through censorship, so they would know little of the rest of the world.**

4. **Despite Stalin's ruthless dictatorial rule, why do you think many people in other countries still found communism an attractive ideology?**

After World War I, the social divide between rich and poor became much greater in many countries. Despite the boom in manufacturing, many people did not benefit from the profits. The poor, including rural workers, and the unemployed would have felt powerless and disenfranchised. An ideology that promoted a classless society — equality for all — would have seemed very attractive, especially for those who had not experienced the reality of life in a communist country.

Fascism- another solution to post-war problems?

Student: Class: Due date:

There were significant fascist movements in many countries, but Italy was the first country where fascists gained power.

1. Post-war Italy was ripe for political change. Comment briefly on the condition of the following aspects of the country.

Environment: Because extensive fighting had taken place on Italian soil, the landscape and towns would have been damaged or destroyed.

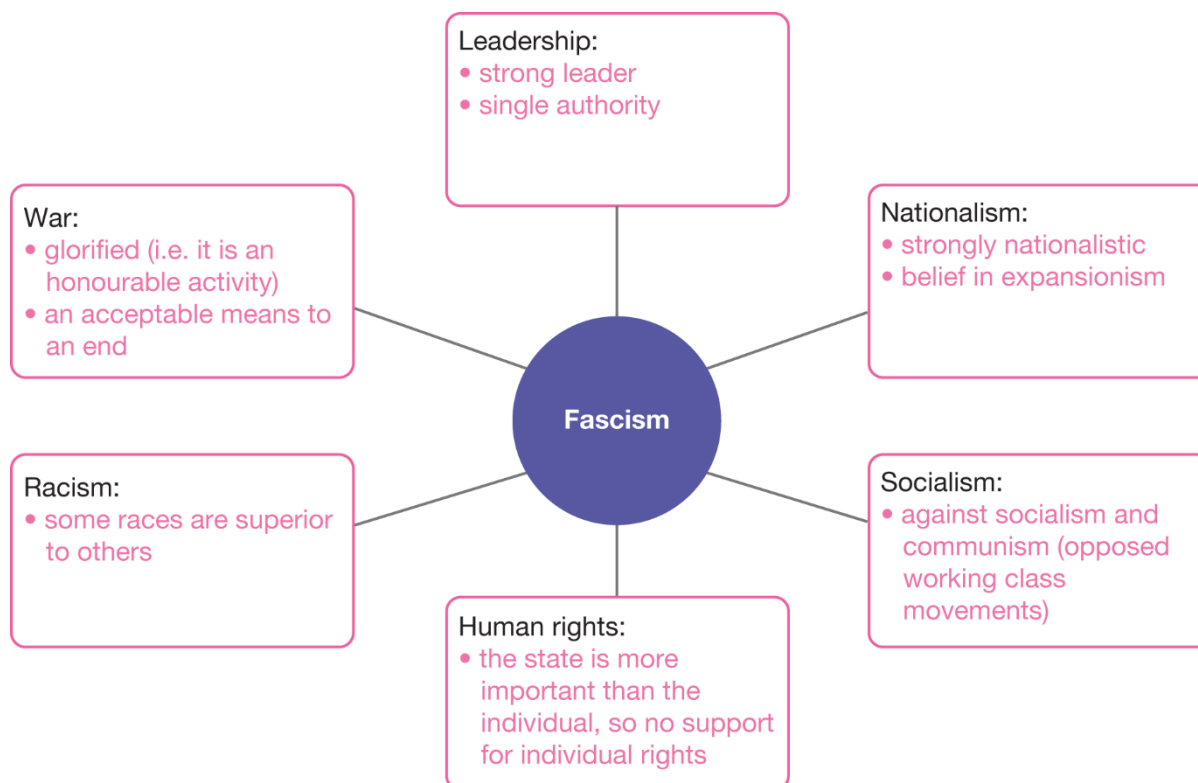
Economy: Italy experienced rapidly rising prices and high unemployment (due partly to ruined farmland and factories, and partly to reparations paid to other nations).

Attitude: Italians resented the outcome of the peace treaties (land loss and reparations).

2. Why do you think many Italians 'feared the influence of socialism and communism'?

Middle-class Italians would have feared the rise and empowerment of the working classes.

3. Complete the mind map to summarise the main features of fascism.



4. Fascism in Australia

- a. In the table below are the names of four right-wing Australian groups. Complete the table by explaining what each name tells us about the group's beliefs, including their attitude towards fascism.

Group	Significance of name
King and Empire Alliance	Members would have been very loyal to Britain and the monarchy and not in favour of communism or socialism.
White Guard	Members may have been racist, believing in white supremacy and may have been sympathetic to fascism.
Sane Democracy League	The name suggests that not all forms of democracy are acceptable to the group; democracy is incompatible with fascism.
New Guard	The name suggests that the nation needs 'guarding' in a new way; it does not sound favourable to democracy.

- b. Why do you think support for right-wing extremism faded as Australia emerged from the Depression?

As the economy improved and unemployment abated, people would have been less desperate for change; in fact, they may have wanted to keep the status quo in order to avoid disrupting the economic recovery.

5. Fascism in Germany

- a. The abdication of the Kaiser, or German monarch, created a power vacuum. What were the contrasting options promoted by German communists and moderate socialists?

i. The communists wanted change by radical revolution.

ii. The socialists wanted reform by parliamentary democracy.

- b. Why do you think fascism was popular among many Germans?

Fascism was more proudly nationalistic than socialism or communism and encouraged belief in racial superiority. Many Germans, especially ex-soldiers, blamed Germany's defeat and humiliation on socialists, communists and Jewish people.

- c. Why do you think the Depression helped the rise of fascism in Germany?

Unemployment and poverty would have made people desperate for change; a strong, nationalist leader such as Hitler would have been attractive.

6. Fascism in Spain

- a. What evidence is there in your textbook to suggest that the new post-war Spanish Republic was a socialist government?

During the Spanish Civil War, the republic received aid from the USSR, but none from capitalist western governments.

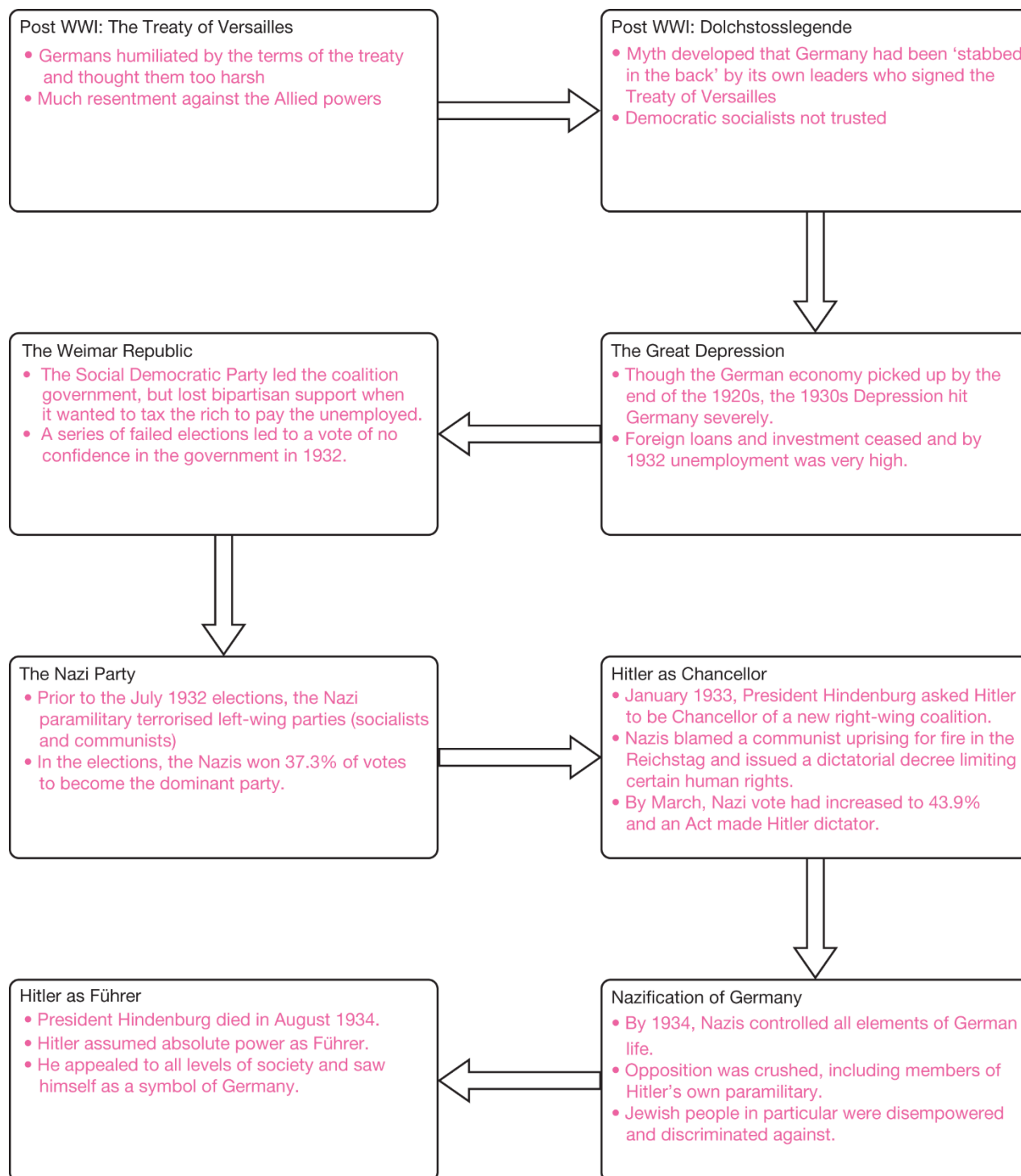
- b. What helped Franco and the fascists to win the Civil War?

They received local support from wealthy landowners and the Catholic Church, and they received aid from other fascist dictators.

The rise of Nazism

Student: Class: Due date:

The main cause of World War II was aggression by the German Nazi regime led by Adolf Hitler. Summarise the development and consolidation of Nazi power by completing the flowchart below. Insert appropriate information, including dates, in dot points under each heading.



Using graphic organisers

Student: Class: Due date:

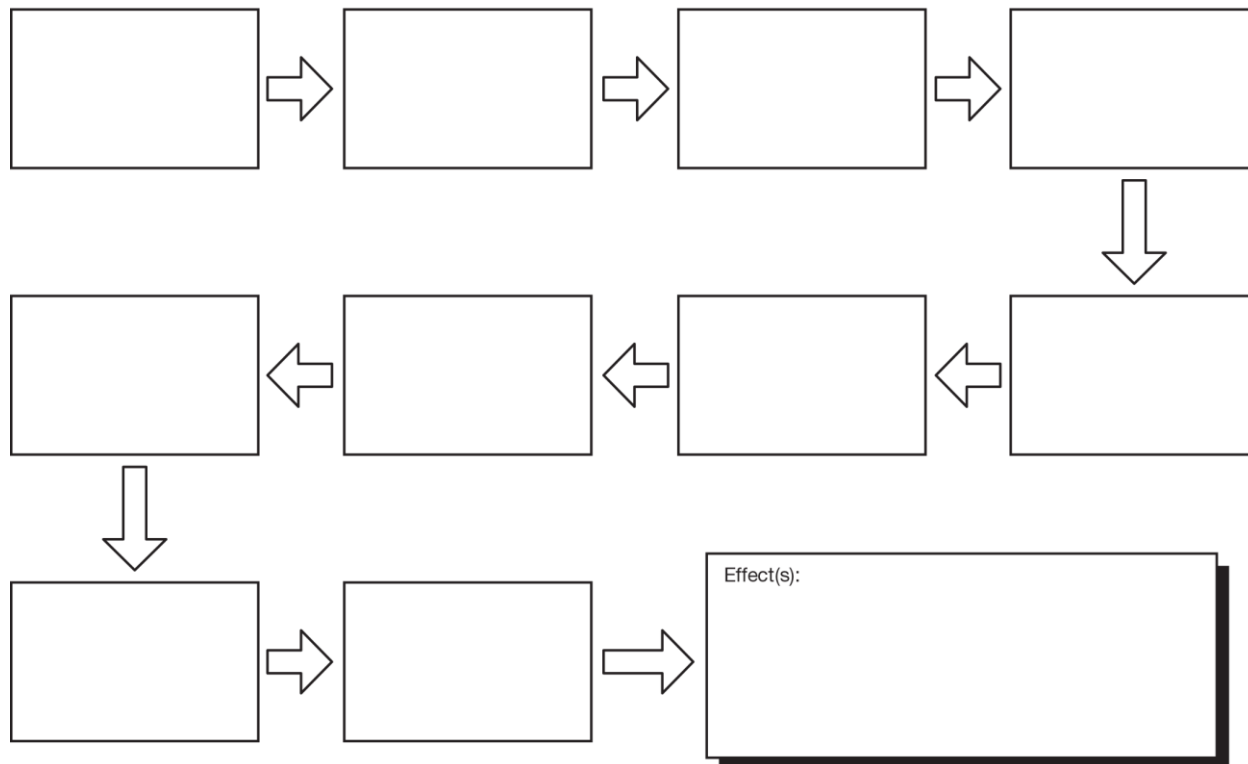
The main cause of the outbreak of World War II in Europe was aggression by the European fascist powers. Summarise the drift to war in Europe by completing the **cause and effect chain** below. Alternatively you can use a different graphic organiser for this task. Insert appropriate information, including dates, in dot points under the following headings:

- Aims of Nazi foreign policy
- Aims of Fascist Italy's foreign policy
- German rearmament
- The ineffectiveness of the League of Nations sanctions against Italy
- The role of the Spanish Civil War in uniting the fascist powers
- The effect of the United States isolationist foreign policy and British and French appeasement
- Failure of Soviet attempts to build United Fronts with Western democracies
- The *Anschluss*
- The destruction of Czechoslovakia
- The threat to Poland.

Cause and effect chain: foreign policies and the drift to World War II

Students' responses will vary.

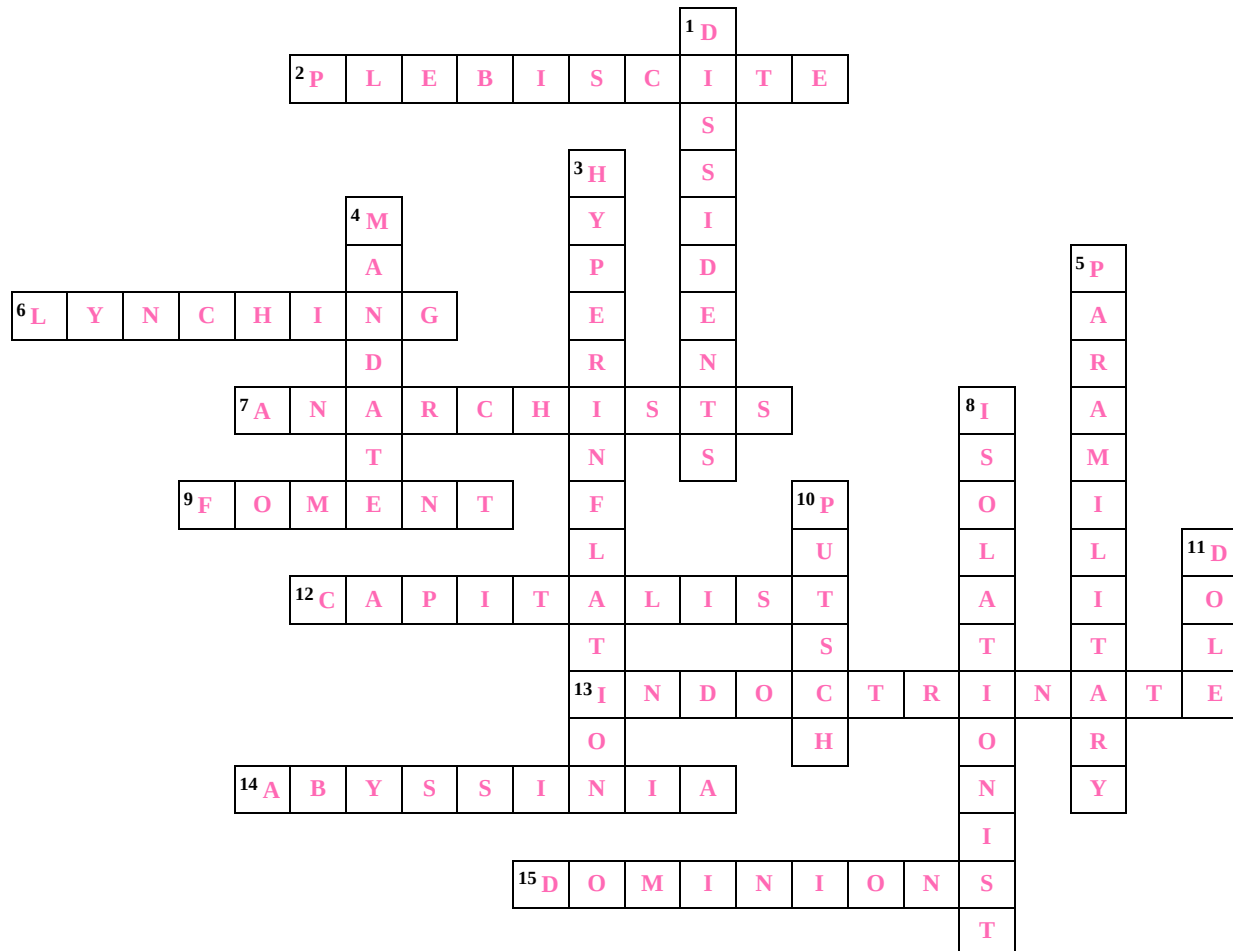
Causes:



Crossword

Student: Class: Due date:

Complete the crossword below.



ACROSS

- 2 direct vote in which electors give their opinion on an issue (10)
- 6 the execution of a person without authority or process of law (8)
- 7 revolutionaries who want an equal society based on cooperation rather than government or coercive laws (10)
- 9 encourage or foster (rebellion) (6)
- 12 economic system based on private ownership of capital, free markets and competition (10)
- 13 to teach or instruct in a way that is almost brainwashing (12)
- 14 the only independent African state in 1935, now called Ethiopia (9)
- 15 the British Empire's self-governing settler colonies (9)

DOWN

- 1 people who publicly disagree with government policy or actions (10)
- 3 such an extreme rise in prices that a currency loses any real value (14)
- 4 commission to act on behalf of the League of Nations to govern a people considered not ready to govern themselves (7)
- 5 armed forces outside the official military (12)
- 8 foreign policy based on avoiding involvement in the affairs of other countries (12)
- 10 an attempt to seize political power by force (6)
- 11 payments to the unemployed, usually in the form of coupons to exchange for food (4)